Kestrel Bikes Staff Handbook

Version 4.2 · September 2026 · A fictional company, made up for this demo.

1. Welcome

Welcome to Kestrel Bikes, a fictional cycling company founded in 2014 in Bristol. We design, build and repair bicycles, and run two shops: the flagship on Gloucester Road and a smaller workshop in Clifton. This handbook explains how we work and what you can expect from us. If anything here is unclear, ask your line manager or email people@kestrelbikes.example.

This handbook applies to everyone on a permanent or fixed-term contract. Contractors and seasonal staff receive a shorter guide. Policies here were last reviewed in September 2026 and are reviewed every twelve months by the People team.

2. Working hours

Our standard working week is 37.5 hours, Monday to Friday, with core hours of 10:00 to 16:00. Outside core hours you can start and finish when it suits you, as long as your team knows. Shop staff work on a rota, published every Thursday for the following two weeks, and are entitled to two consecutive days off each week.

Overtime must be agreed in advance by your line manager. It is paid at 1.5 times your hourly rate, or you can take it as time off in lieu within three months.

3. Annual leave

Full-time staff receive 27 days of annual leave plus UK bank holidays. After three years of continuous service you gain one extra day per year, up to a maximum of 30 days. Part-time staff receive a pro-rata allowance.

Our leave year runs from 1 January to 31 December. You may carry over up to five unused days into the next year; carried-over days must be used by 31 March or they are lost. Book leave through the HR portal with at least two weeks' notice for anything longer than three days. Shop staff should avoid booking leave in April and May, our busiest months, unless agreed with the shop manager.

Everyone also gets their birthday off, in addition to their annual leave allowance. If your birthday falls on a weekend, take the nearest working day.

4. Sickness

If you are ill, tell your line manager by phone or message before 09:30 on your first day of absence. For absences of up to seven calendar days you can self-certify through the HR portal. For longer absences we need a fit note from a doctor.

We pay full salary for up to 10 days of sickness in any rolling 12-month period, after which Statutory Sick Pay applies. If you have more than three separate absences in six months, your line manager will arrange an informal, supportive chat.

5. Remote and hybrid working

Office-based staff can work from home up to three days a week. Tuesdays are our team day, when everyone office-based is expected in the Bristol office. Shop and workshop roles are fully on site.

We provide a laptop, a monitor and a one-off home office allowance of £300 for a chair, desk or other equipment. Claim it through the expenses system within your first three months.

6. Expenses

Claim business expenses through the expenses system within 60 days of spending the money, attaching a photo of the receipt. Claims are paid with the next monthly salary run if submitted before the 20th of the month.

Rail travel should be standard class. Mileage in your own car is reimbursed at 45p per mile, or 20p per mile if you cycle on company business. Meals while travelling are covered up to £25 per day. Alcohol is never reimbursed.

7. Benefits

All staff receive a 40% discount on Kestrel bikes and a 25% discount on parts and accessories, plus one free full service per year on a personal bike. We offer a cycle-to-work scheme for any brand, up to £3,000.

Our pension scheme matches employee contributions up to 6% of salary. You can also book up to 4 hours a year of free sessions with our employee assistance programme, which offers confidential counselling and financial advice.

Each person has a learning budget of £750 per year for courses, books or conferences related to their role. Unused budget does not roll over.

8. Leaving Kestrel

The notice period is one month for staff in their first year and two months after that, unless your contract says otherwise. Please return your laptop, keys and any company tools on your last day. Unused annual leave is paid in your final salary.